The Dunes Newsletter

Board Members:

Qin Chen, President (Qin@abtsthedunes.com)
Belinda White, Vice President
(Belindaw@abtsthedunes.com)
Harriet Thompson, Secretary
(HThompson@abtsthedunes.com)

Committee Chairs

TBD Architectural & Aesthetics (architectural@abtsthedunes.com)
Marc Levine, Governance (governance@abtsthedunes.com)
DJ, Traffic and Safety (trafficandsafety@abtsthedunes.com)
TBD, Events
Roger Eller, Finance (Finance@abtsthedunes.com)
Bill Zlata, Landscape (landscape@abtsthedunes.com)
Pamela Foster, Sanitation (prfoster2@gmail.com)

News Items:

Board Meeting – February 27, 2025

The Board convened on February 27, 2025 and discussed the following topics

- Legal actions to collect maintenance arrears – review and discussion of various accounts.
- Open Payables – all accounts current.
- Financials – review of all account balances.
- NOC/NOV procedure change – Notices to Cure will no longer be issued. In accordance with our governing regulations, the Declarations and bylaw, Notice of Violations and subsequently, Notice of Violations with fines will be issued.
- HOA Membership Suspension – amendments were made to the suspension notice. Homeowners in arrears of $1,000.00 shall be suspended and car subject to towing.
- Homeowner in collection – Legal action will continue to be commenced against homeowners that owe $2,000.00 in maintenance and/or violations.

- Road and Speed bump update – agreed to authorize Asphalt Company to replace defective speed bump on Saltaire; to correct parking lot cracks on Compass, and repair cracks on Seaspray.
- Bollard replacement (Seaspray & Beach Way crossing) – Board approved two (2) bollard installation. After further review of area by the company, there are no electrical conduits there and the cost is excessive. The Board is examining other options.
- 2025 Parking Policy – Board amended and approved parking policy. It will be posted shortly.
- 2025 Sanitation Policy – Board amended and approved sanitation policy. It will be posted shortly.

New Policies available for review and they will go into effect starting on September 1, 2024, these will supersede any previous policy/rules.

- House Rules
- Sanitation Policy
- Parking Policy
- All these policies can be found at:
    - https://www.abtsdunes.com/documents-1/

Finance Committee

- Finance committee are reviewing Q2 financials
- Finance committee cleared Brightview proposal schedule for Linden Tree disease treatment.

Landscape Committee

Overall, the grass throughout the community is looking very nice and healthy. Brightview has done a great job.

Landscaping committee and Brightview are working together to resolve irrigation problems including the high mineral content of the water in various part of the community which causes the rust-looking stains on our fences.

The Linden trees that were uprooted and rotten have been removed and replaced.

Social Committee

We need homeowners to volunteer for the social committee to help coordinate/plan activities for the community. All hands on deck would be greatly appreciated.

Traffic & Safety Committee

BANDE Automotive LLC, our new towing company are more active in removing illegally parked vehicles. Many homeowners have given a "two thumbs up" for their excellence in service to our community.

Please be mindful when parking your vehicle that your parking tag is clearly displayed in the front of the vehicle. The recommended location for your parking tag is to use the hook on the tag to hang it from the arm of the rear view mirror. Unfortunately, cars have been towed for tags that have fallen to the car floor because the owner put the tag on the dashboard which fell to the car floor.

The required repairs have been completed by our Asphalt Company to replace defective speed bump on Saltaire; to correct parking lot cracks on Compass, and repair cracks on Seaspray. Lastly, the compass parking lot where there was evidence of excessive sloping and asphalt damage has been resolved.

School construction activity:

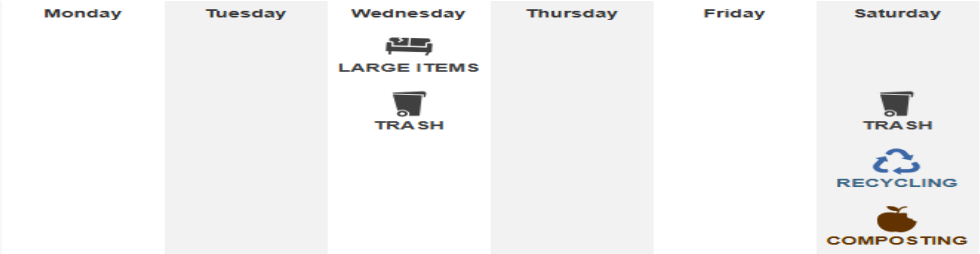
The Board meet with the owner and the construction crew of new school. All of the concerns of our community were presented to the owner and we were assured that they would be cooperative and coordinate with us to resolve any issues that affect our community. We will also be able to participate any some of their local events and were welcomed to use their facility for the appropriate events. The information we have for the school opening will be at current there will be a soft opening around end of Oct, and the target will be current students. Final school age group is still to be determined after the department of Education takes over the property.

Sanitation Committee:

This brief summary is not intended to replace the current sanitation policy that is on the website. The new summary and policy guidelines will be posted on our website in the near future.

Effective on November 12, 2024, the NYC Council passed new laws and regulations that require residential trash containerization.

- Residents must use containers, not exceeding 55 gallons in capacity, with secure closed lids for all trash/garbage placed curbside for collection.
- Failure to use proper bins will result in fines issued by the NYC Department of Sanitation.
- Residents may continue to use non-compliant bins until **June 1, 2026**; on that date, all residents will be required to switch to the Official NYC Bin.
- NYC Bins may be purchased at www.bins.nyc, at any NYC Home Depot location (same price as online) or by calling 1-855-NYC-BINS.
- Bins can only be stored on your driveway, in your garage or behind your rear yard fence except for our row houses. The board is working with the row houses owners for a solution to their unique problem of not having a driveway.
- Be advised that storing bins on the grass has caused damage to the sprinkler heads and adversely effects the operation of the sprinkler system. Notice of violations will be issued for noncompliance with this important rule and homeowners may be held responsible for the cost to damaged sprinkler heads.
- Collection dates in illustration:



- **Consider Joining Our Sanitation Committee**
    - Consider joining the new Dunes Sanitation Committee if you would like to spend time with neighbors to maintain and improve the ongoing management of trash and special projects. There are great options for you if you would like to start as a street or block captain. Additional choices available to get involved via communications. Please contact: Pamela Foster, Sanitation (prfoster2@gmail.com)

Architectural and Aesthetics Committee:

Excessive algae has been observed on the trellis and siding of the homes. Be reminded that keeping your home in good condition is for your benefit and overall aesthetics of the community.

The AA Committee would like to remind all homeowners:

- Velcro screens must be white only. Black Velcro screens are not permitted.
- Garage doors must be painted if they are rusted.
- Please do not place rugs, towels, bathing suits, etc. on the railings to dry outdoors.
- Bicycles chained to poles are interfering with the landscapers duties to maintain the grass. Please remove them immediately. Brightview are authorized to clip and remove any bicycles chained to light poles and trees. The bikes will be put in the garbage unless the identity of the owner is clearly shown on the bike.
- Fire pits can be very dangerous to homeowners and the environment, especially if they are not properly placed in your yard and require constant observation. Never step away from an operating fire pit. Fire pits should be placed at a safe distance (10-25 feet) from any flammable structures or surfaces. This includes your house, trees and shrubs, and your neighbors' property.
- Grass in our back yards must be mowed on a regular basis.
- Please ensure that your shrubs, vines and vegetation are not growing into your neighbor's property.
- Gentle Reminder-an application must be submitted to the AA Committee for any modifications/additions to the outside of your home and rear yard.

Pet Waste:

To date, the HOA supplies free pet waste bags on posts throughout the park. We have purchased signage as a reminder to clean up after your pets. We have sent constant reminders to curb your dogs in almost every newsletter. We have included a similar pet clause in our sanitation policy guidelines, and have posted a one-page flyer on all homeowner and tenant front doors that included a reminder to pick up after your pets. Despite all our good faith efforts to keep the community free of pet feces in the park, sidewalks and on our streets, we have an uptick in complaints about pet waste.

In response to these increasing complaints of pet waste on street, sidewalks, and parks, pet owners/walkers will be issued HOA fines of up to $250.00 if there is evidence of such neglect or if reported and captured on camera leaving their pet's waste.

Responsible pet owners must pick up after their pets! Picking up after your pet is not only common courtesy, but it is your duty as a pet owner. Let's work together. Each resident should become more vigilant and report anyone leaving pet waste behind. Please submit your complaint, along with evidence, to the Board via email or through the Dunes Website, https://www.abtsthedunes.com. Homeowners must alert their tenants of this new policy. Homeowners will be held accountable for their tenant's neglect.

Parking Regulations:

It is unlawful to park a car in the direction opposite the flow of traffic. To avoid being fined or towed, please ensure that your car is parked in the correct direction.

The parking policy for the HOA has been updated to include the tag replacement costs and the policy can be found here:

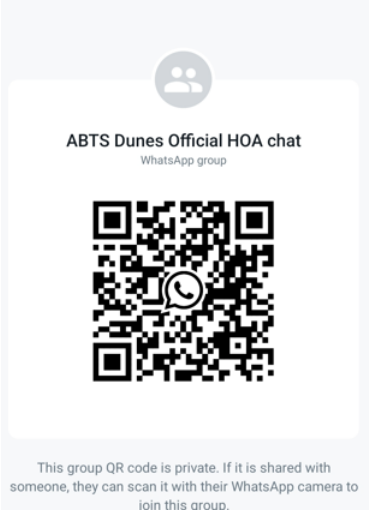
https://www.abtsdunes.com/documents-1/

Streetlights:

- Please notify the board should you notice a street light that is out of order in the community.
- Please let us know the street name as well as the number on the pole that will help expedite any repairs.

HOA Chat:

- Like any internet communication, it is requested that you are respectful in all of your written communications. Insults, profanity, personal slurs and the like will not be tolerated and will be removed.
- Join the official HOA chat for the latest news and for questions submitted and answered by the Board and Committee Chairs, using the link https://chat.whatsapp.com/DyMuCpr5XAdAfy9mQMbXih.
- Or the QR Code:

- 

"QUICK LINKS'… TO OUR DUNES WEBSITE

- COMMUNITY DISCUSSION BOARD: Check out **LET'S TALK**, our new discussion board created for the community to chat with the Board. Let's Talk is located under 'WELCOME' in our website or by clicking on this link (https://www.abtsdunes.com/board-message-board/).
- PARKING REGULATIONS: Valid parking tags must be displayed at all times when parking on the streets in the Dunes, as well as when blocking your driveway. Link to parking regulations https://www.abtsdunes.com/documents-1/.
- HOUSE RULES: Click on this link https://www.abtsdunes.com/documents-1/ to review updated HOUSE RULES.
- UPCOMING EVENTS : Click on this link (https://www.abtsdunes.com/calendar/) to view our upcoming events.
- LOCAL NEWS: Click on this link (https://www.abtsdunes.com/what-you-should-know-1/) to read local news.
- REAL ESTATE SECTION: Selling your home? Have an apartment to rent? Click on this link (https://www.abtsdunes.com/homes-for-sale-or-rent/) to complete an application.

- REPORT A PROBLEM: Click on this link (https://www.abtsdunes.com/request-manager/?view=usersubmit&cat=1) to report a problem.
- TEMPORARY PARKING PERMITS: Click on this link (http://www.abtsdunes.com/request-manager/?view=usersubmit&cat=4) to apply for temporary PARKING PERMITS. Only primary resident owners may submit temporary pass requests.
- ARCHITECTURAL/LANDSCAPE APPLICATION: Click on this link (https://www.abtsdunes.com/request-manager/?view=usersubmit&cat=3) to apply.

2024

Dunes Residents Sanitation Policy Summary

Why Do Waste Management Guidelines Matter?

HELP MAINTAIN AESTHETICS
Preserve the visual charm of each residence, allowing all residents to enjoy the beauty of our neighborhood.

KEEP WILD ANIMALS AWAY
Our community is particularly vulnerable to sea gulls, pigeons and crows that tear apart loose trash piles and are consistently attracted to white grocery and trash bags.

PREVENT IDENTITY THEFT
When homeowners keep bins out of sight, or less accessible, potential thieves cannot get to them.

Join the **Sanitation Committee**!
We have room for many to work in sections of the community.
Contact WEN or a Board member to join.

Visit **www.abtsdunes.com** and register to access valuable resident resources.

A **schedule of fines** will be posted on the website and updated regularly.

What Are Our Priority Concerns in the Dunes Community?

- Garbage placed out too early
- Unsecured boxes and packing materials
- Scattered garbage in the community due to windy conditions
- Delayed retrieval of bins/items that were uncollected after collection on Wednesdays & Sundays
- Placing garbage in front of others' homes or on corners
- Use of non-black bags (prone to seagull ripping) or uncovered receptacles
- Paint cans in the garbage (environmental and safety hazard)

Did you know? You can report any non-pickup by sanitation to the local sanitation garage. Call 718-734-3711 or dial 311.

Be a Good Neighbor - Know the House Rules:

****Bins for Trash****
- Utilize covered, leak-proof bins not exceeding 55 gallons, placed at the curb on collection days. Attached lids are preferred.
- Keep bins closed at all times.
- Compost materials using the NYC-provided brown compost bins.

****Bags for Trash****
- Securely tie all bags.
- Never use white bags; opt for black bags for trash.
- Paper and cardboard should be secured using rope, tape, or clear bags—no loose stacks of boxes.
- Use clear bags for glass and plastic and clear or blue bags for recyclable paper.
- Compost materials using the NYC-provided brown compost bins.

****Recycling****
- Adhere to both city and community recycling rules.

****Large Items****
- Maximum size of items for regular pick up is no larger than 2 feet by four feet and wrapped/packaged securely.

****Hazardous Waste****
- Never place hazardous waste in any trash containers.

****HOA Rules****
- Follow the rules set by the Homeowners Association (HOA) to support a clean, attractive community.

****Pet Waste****
- Pick up and dispose of dog feces in your own trash receptacle.

****Community Mail Boxes****
- Refrain from attaching any printed material to mailboxes or lamp posts within the community.